

Reading for precise information

Component 1 · Exercise 1 · 8 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Skim the topic, scan for names and conditions, then give a short answer that fits the question.

The 0511 qualification includes Reading and Writing (50%), Listening (25%) and Speaking (25%). Each component is compulsory. These FagusED texts and tasks are newly written; the June 2026 materials supplied were consulted for page layout.

Skimming and scanning

Skim for the overall subject before hunting for details. Circle key words in the question, scan for a paraphrase in the text and reread the surrounding sentence. A date, reason and condition are different information types. The last question requires three distinct answers.

Worked example

“When may the students use the room?” → three afternoons a week, before the library closes at six.
The answer to “why was the room useful?” is different: thick walls reduced noise.

Avoid near matches

Questions often place a tempting but wrong fact close to the right one. Check the timeframe and the person: the teacher visits Thursdays, while the library closes at six. Use one word or phrase for most answers.

Worked example

If asked what the caretaker advised, “open the small window safely and close it when leaving” is relevant; a fan was only a request.

Practice paper

Reading for precise information

Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Reading text · about 400-450 words

Finding a place to practise

When Hana joined the school orchestra, she played her violin in the classroom after lessons. It was

quiet there until a sports club began using the room next door. She could still hear herself, but she kept losing her place whenever the club opened its heavy door. At home, her younger brother was preparing for his own music exam, so they took turns using the living room.

Hana asked the music teacher about the empty room above the library. The teacher explained that the room was usually locked because it stored old chairs. Hana and two other students offered to help clear it. They worked for one Saturday morning, moving the chairs to a storage area with the caretaker's permission. The library manager then agreed that orchestra members could use the room three afternoons a week, provided they signed in and finished before the library closed at six.

At first, the new room seemed perfect. Its thick walls reduced the sound that reached the readers below. After a month, however, the students noticed that the room became warm and stuffy. They asked for a fan. Instead, the caretaker showed them how to open a small window safely and reminded them to close it before leaving. The manager also asked them to keep instrument cases away from the fire exit. No money was needed for either improvement.

The room has changed the way the group works. Hana says that regular practice has made it easier for her to perform short solos without stopping. She and the other students also listen to each other and give specific advice, rather than simply playing their own pieces. The teacher visits on Thursdays to help them prepare for their end-of-term concert.

The library manager is pleased with the arrangement, although she will review it after the concert. On one occasion, the group finished late and another member of staff had to wait to lock the building. Hana has therefore added a reminder to the sign-in sheet. She hopes the practice room will remain available to next year's orchestra, even when she has left the school.

Other students have already asked if they can book the room for different activities. The manager says the current agreement applies only to the orchestra, because the school must first check whether other groups would disturb readers. Hana thinks a simple weekly timetable might help everyone share the space. For now, she is concentrating on the concert and reminding her friends to leave the room as they found it.

Read the article and answer Questions 1–6. Questions 1–5 require one short answer. Question 6 requires three different answers.

1. Where did Hana practise before the sports club used the room next door? [1]

2. What room did Hana ask to use? [1]

3. Who gave permission to move the old chairs? [1]

4. What time did the library close? [1]

5. On which day did the teacher visit the group? [1]

6. Give three ways the students made or kept the practice room suitable for use. [3]

Answers and explanations

1. the classroom [1]. The wording may be paraphrased, but the detail must identify the relevant person, time or reason.

2. the room above the library [1]. The wording may be paraphrased, but the detail must identify the relevant person, time or reason.

3. the caretaker [1]. The wording may be paraphrased, but the detail must identify the relevant person, time or reason.

4. six / 6.00 [1]. The wording may be paraphrased, but the detail must identify the relevant person, time or reason.

5. Thursdays [1]. The wording may be paraphrased, but the detail must identify the relevant person, time or reason.

6. cleared old chairs; opened/closed the window safely; kept cases away from the fire exit / signed in / finished on time [3]. The wording may be paraphrased, but the detail must identify the relevant person, time or reason.

Checking your work

Read the question again after finding the evidence. Do not add a second, conflicting answer. For multi-point questions, count distinct details.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.